Daily Content Intel

July 23, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so there's a systematic review out of Cureus this year that looked at the Thrower's Ten program across eight studies, in baseball, handball, cricket, badminton, all these overhead sports, and the finding was pretty clean. Every single study showed positive outcomes, no matter the sport or the level.

Here's what that program actually trains. The rotator cuff, the scapular stabilizers, and the forearm. The small stuff. The muscles that decelerate your arm after you let go of the ball, or the lacrosse shot, or the serve.

And that's the part athletes miss. Everybody wants to throw harder, so they train the big movers, the chest, the lat, the legs. But your arm slows down through those little cuff and scapular muscles, and if they're weak, that's where the pain shows up.

The review found improvements in range of motion, strength, and stability across the board, and better throwing accuracy too. So it's more than durability. It carries onto the field.

The dose is simple. Three sessions a week, six to eight weeks, and you tailor it to wherever you're weak. Bands, light dumbbells, that's it. You can do it in the corner of any weight room.

If your arm barks when you throw, build the small muscles first, before you shut it down for rest. Rest gives you a quiet arm that's still weak.

Does that make sense? Train the small muscles, protect the big performance.

Hook: If you throw, shoot, or serve, your shoulder is only as durable as the small muscles holding it together.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so there's a systematic review out of Cureus this year that looked at the Thrower's Ten program across eight studies, in baseball, handball, cricket, badminton, all these overhead sports, and the finding was pretty clean. Every single study showed positive outcomes, no matter the sport or the level.

Here's what that program actually trains. The rotator cuff, the scapular stabilizers, and the forearm. The small stuff. The muscles that decelerate your arm after you let go of the ball, or the lacrosse shot, or the serve.

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Does that make sense? Train the small muscles, protect the big performance.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Your throwing arm is only as durable as the small muscles
- 0:08 Thrower's Ten: 8 studies, 6 overhead sports

- 0:16 Trains: rotator cuff + scapular stabilizers + forearm
- 0:26 These muscles decelerate your arm after release
- 0:38 Better strength, ROM, stability, and throwing accuracy
- 0:52 Dose: 3x/week, 6 to 8 weeks, bands + light dumbbells
- 1:05 Build the small muscles before you rest the arm
- 1:15 Train the small muscles, protect the big performance

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Arm pain in overhead athletes usually starts small. Weak rotator cuff. Weak scapular muscles. The stuff that decelerates your arm after the ball leaves your hand.

A 2025 systematic review looked at the Thrower's Ten program across 8 studies and 6 different overhead sports. Every study showed positive outcomes, no matter the sport or level. Better strength, better range of motion, better stability, better throwing accuracy.

The dose is simple. 3 sessions a week for 6 to 8 weeks. Bands and light dumbbells. You tailor it to wherever you're weak.

If your arm barks when you throw, build the small muscles first, before you shut it down for rest.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.
threshold.clientsecure.me

#throwingathlete #armcare #baseballtraining #lacrosse #overheadathlete #rotatorcuff #shoulderhealth #athletictraining #strengthandconditioning #sportsPT #injuryprevention #returntosport

Personalize this

- You program HS football and work a NoVA lacrosse audience. Which overhead or throwing athletes have come to you with arm pain that traced back to weak cuff or scapular muscles, and what showed up on their exam?
- What's your go-to arm-care circuit for a lacrosse or overhead athlete in-season, and how do you fit 3 sessions a week

around their practice and game load?
- Have you held an athlete back on a return-to-throw call until their rotator cuff and scapular strength hit a threshold? What did you measure it with (strength symmetry side to side, cuff endurance)?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12633846/ | "Rehabilitative and Preventive Effects of the Thrower's Ten Program in Overhead Athletes: A Systematic Review"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12633846/ | "Across all eight studies, T10 produced positive outcomes, regardless of sport or competitive level."
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12633846/ | "A frequency of three sessions per week for six to eight weeks appears effective, but tailoring to baseline deficits and sport-specific demands is advisable."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12633846/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. If you're doing squats on a BOSU ball to get more explosive, you're wasting reps.

There's a 2025 meta-analysis in Physiological Reports, 14 trials, 450 athletes, looking at instability training, so wobble boards, BOSU balls, unstable surfaces. And the results are actually pretty useful once you separate two things.

Balance. It works great for balance. Single-leg standing, Y balance test, big improvements. If your sport lives on postural control, there's a real place for it.

Jumping and power. That's where it falls apart. For the countermovement jump, which is basically your athletic power test, they pooled seven studies and got an effect size of basically zero. Zero. The wobble board did not make athletes jump higher.

And it makes sense. The second you put a heavy squat on an unstable surface, your body pulls back on force output to keep you from tipping over. You can't express power and fight for balance at the same time. So you train the balancing, and the power just sits there.

The authors say it straight. Heavy strength training on stable ground is what builds lower-limb power. Save the unstable stuff for balance and core control.

So here's the call. If you want to jump higher and run faster, put a barbell on your back on solid ground and load it. Use the wobble board as the garnish. The barbell is the meal.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Balancing on a wobbly surface builds balance. It does almost nothing for your vertical.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. If you're doing squats on a BOSU ball to get more explosive, you're wasting reps.

There's a 2025 meta-analysis in Physiological Reports, 14 trials, 450 athletes, looking at instability training, so wobble boards, BOSU balls, unstable surfaces. And the results are actually pretty useful once you separate two things.

Balance. It works great for balance. Single-leg standing, Y balance test, big improvements. If your sport lives on postural control, there's a real place for it.

Jumping and power. That's where it falls apart. For the countermovement jump, which is basically your athletic power test, they pooled seven studies and got an effect size of basically zero. Zero. The wobble board did not make athletes jump higher.

And it makes sense. The second you put a heavy squat on an unstable surface, your body pulls back on force output to keep you from tipping over. You can't express power and fight for balance at the same time. So you train the balancing, and the power just sits there.

The authors say it straight. Heavy strength training on stable ground is what builds lower-limb power. Save the unstable stuff for balance and core control.

So here's the call. If you want to jump higher and run faster, put a barbell on your back on solid ground and load it. Use the wobble board as the garnish. The barbell is the meal.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 BOSU squats for power = wasted reps
- 0:08 2025 meta-analysis: 14 trials, 450 athletes
- 0:18 Balance: big improvements (single-leg, Y balance)

- 0:30 Countermovement jump: effect size basically ZERO
- 0:42 Unstable surface = body pulls back on force output
- 0:52 You can't express power and fight for balance at once
- 1:02 Heavy strength on stable ground builds power
- 1:12 Barbell is the meal, wobble board is the garnish

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Balancing on a wobbly surface builds one thing well. Balance.

A 2025 meta-analysis in Physiological Reports pooled 14 trials and 450 athletes on instability training. Wobble boards and BOSU balls improved single-leg balance and Y balance scores a lot. For jumping power, the countermovement jump, they pooled 7 studies and the effect was basically zero.

The reason is simple. Load a squat on an unstable surface and your body pulls back on force to keep you upright. You can't express power and fight for balance in the same rep.

The researchers put it plainly. Heavy strength training on stable ground builds lower-limb power. Instability work is for balance and core control.

Want to jump higher and run faster. Load a barbell on solid ground. Use the wobble board as the garnish.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.
threshold.clientsecure.me

#strengthtraining #athleticperformance #bosu #balancetraining #verticaljump #powertraining #strengthandconditioning #sportscience #athletedevelopment #speedtraining #footballtraining #lacrosse

Personalize this

- Which athletes have shown up to you having burned an offseason on BOSU or unstable-surface work, and what did their vertical or change-of-direction actually look like when you tested them?
- Where's your line in the CROSS framework between single-leg and

unstable work in a rehab / return-to-sport phase versus chasing power on the platform?

- For your HS football and lacrosse athletes on only 2-3 lifts a week, what's your stable-ground strength priority, and how do you talk parents and coaches out of the "balance equals athleticism" idea?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12612598/ | "The effects of instability training on balance and jump performance in athletes: A systematic review and meta-analysis"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12612598/ | "For countermovement jump, a meta-analysis of seven studies indicated a small pooled effect size with high heterogeneity"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12612598/ | "traditional high-load strength training remains more effective for enhancing lower-limb power, whereas instability training is better suited for activities requiring balance regulation,

core control, and multidirectional stability"

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12612598/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Youth baseball dominant-arm ER/IR strength negatively correlated with throwing arm pain (IJSPT 2024, PMC11534161) — pairs well as a companion to the Thrower's Ten piece.
- Proprioceptive / balance-board training reduces ankle sprain recurrence, strongest for athletes with prior sprain history (2026 CAI systematic review, PMC12786792).
- IMTP reliability and its link to reactive strength index in youth athletes — a "how to test if your strength work is transferring" explainer.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-07-23.pdf): 3 sources. Mercola "The Pain May Be Just the Beginning" (pure promo, skipped). Mike T. Nelson Flex Diet ep. 396 with attorney Rick Collins on peptide legality / BPC-157 / TB-500 FDA compounding hearing (regulatory, not athlete-actionable, and BPC-157 already cited 2026-06-22, skipped). Second Mercola supplement email (filtered, no content).

- PubMed / PMC: overhead-athlete arm care, rotator cuff / scapular strength, Thrower's Ten; ankle sprain proprioceptive training; IMTP / reactive strength youth athletes; instability / unstable-surface training and power transfer. Surfaced the two picks below plus runners-up.
- Cureus 2025 systematic review on Thrower's Ten in overhead athletes — clean, athlete-actionable, untouched lane → Draft A.
- Physiological Reports 2025 meta-analysis on instability training (balance vs. jump) — provocative, method-focused, untouched lane → Draft B.
- Registry dedup: both primary URLs checked against cited-sources.json (90-day window). No hits. Recent registry is heavy on sprint/plyo/deceleration,

hamstring/ACL, nutrition/creatine/protein, sleep, and recovery modalities — both picks avoid all of those.

- Unreachable: Wiley full-text for the instability meta (403); used the open-access PMC mirror instead. IJSPT youth-baseball ER/IR study read as a runner-up.